Only three months after the London Agreement, the prime minister gradually began to change his mind about King Hussein and Jordan. While the London Agreement contained the possibility of returning the West Bank, an independent dialogue with Hussein opened the strategic option of removing the threat of a front east of Israel's borders.

In July 1987, the first meeting between Prime Minister Shamir and the king took place. This meeting shaped the future relationship between the two, which was characterized by genuine chemistry and mutual trust, despite differences of opinion on core issues.

In March 1990, a technical meeting was held between Efraim, the deputy director of the Mossad, and his Jordanian counterpart in London, which developed into a meeting with the king. This meeting marked the beginning of a new chapter in the relations between the two countries—that of the First Gulf War. As you will remember, King Hussein sided with Saddam Hussein. In the meetings that took place on the eve of Saddam's invasion of Kuwait, we warned the king not to allow Saddam to use Jordanian territory. This led to the next meeting between him and Prime Minister Shamir, which took place in the first week of January 1991, about a week before the outbreak of the First Gulf War. This meeting also took place in London. Ehud Barak, then-IDF deputy chief of staff, joined the group as well. During the conversation, the king promised not to allow the Iraqi air force to use Jordanian airspace to attack Israel and not to allow Iraqi ground forces to use Jordanian territory. In return, Shamir pledged to the king that Israel would respect Jordan's sovereignty and territorial integrity.

The Gulf War left King Hussein on his throne and the Kingdom of Jordan unharmed. Hussein saw this as a great achievement.

The cabinet meetings during the First Gulf War were held in the Templar building on the base of the General Staff. Meetings were held daily, sometimes even twice a day. In addition to the ministers, the entire top echelon of the security forces was present at the meetings. I remember—how could I forget—the tremendous pressure exerted by the top brass on the prime minister to take a decision regarding the IDF's intervention in the war, and the steadfast and uncompromising stance that the prime minister took, sometimes alone, against their recommendation. Among the thoughts that went through my mind at that time was that the decision not to do something is sometimes much harder than the decision to do something! On